

AIM

AP.090 MANAGERS READINESS PLAN

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Introduction

Purpose

The purpose of this document is to assist the middle and first line managers in understanding the project vision, how it impacts their department and teams, and how they can best get involved to achieve the targeted business benefits. Middle and first line managers participate in the effort to determine how the organization will improve its performance, enabled by the new technology and lead the effort to convert the business benefits at the role level performance expectations. Also, this document helps middle and first line managers define their role as change agents throughout the life of the <Project Name>.

Overview

This document includes the following components:

Component	Description
Introduction	Shows the outline for the work session(s).
Managers' Induction	Exposes middle and firstline managers to the highlights of the project. Included here is the review of the vision, benefits, expected results, alignment with Information Technology and corporate strategy, and the overall project strategy. Exposes middle and firstline managers to the features and functions of the application to the processes, in terms of how the application can improve the way the departments operate.
Application to Process Overview	Identifies the modules and associated topics relevant to the departments' processes.
Organizational Performance Improvement Strategy	Guides the middle managers to convert the organizational performance objectives to the role levels and to lead the task forces to define the procedure documentation (Oracle Tutor) and the new required human performance support systems.
Change Leadership Guiding Principles and Roles	Describes the guiding principles of change and highlights the role of middle and firstline managers as change leaders.
Managers' Communication Guide	Highlights the role middle and firstline managers play as communication agents/liaisons.

Session Overview

Purpose

This Managers Readiness session assembled the middle managers to expose them to the vision of the project, and to help them define how their department through its various activities could best contribute to organizational performance improvement with the benefit of the technology. As a result of the session, the middle managers converted the organizational performance improvement strategy to the role level and initiated tasks forces to document procedures and update the human performance support systems for the newly defined roles. They then held similar work sessions with their first line managers for further involvement in the change process.

The work sessions were highly interactive and focused on decision making around key questions to make sure that the organization could achieve the targeted business objectives:

- How are the changes in business processes impacting the performance of my department/team?
- How do the role-based performance expectations map to the department performance goals?
- What measures do we need to put in place to achieve the targeted organizational performance improvements?
- Who should be involved in the update of the Human Performance Support Systems (HPSS) and what are the HPSS high-level requirements?
- How can middle managers and first line managers fulfill their role as business sponsors for the project?

The work sessions looked at ways of answering these questions and examined the organizational issues relevant to the organizational performance improvement strategy at the department and role levels for a successful achievement of the targeted business benefits.

Facilitation

The work session was facilitated by <Facilitator Name> from

<Facilitator Name> Biographical Notes:

In addition, <Scribe's Name> attended the session to keep a record of all decisions made during the meeting and keep deliverables updated at all times throughout the session.

Attendees

The following attendees participated in the readiness events:

Organization	Name of Attendees	Title
<Company Long Name>		
Contract Resources		

Outline

The following outlines the activities conducted in the sessions:

Sections	Description	Time	Duration
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Sections	Description	Time	Duration
Introduction Give background for the decision to go ahead with the project Introduce and welcome managers, including in each introduction, a brief statement of how important this person is to the success of the project. For session with middle managers: Make the point that the participants will in turn lead a similar induction session with the first line managers reporting to them Describe the benefits of the project to the organization, to the departments in the business unit and to the individuals themselves. Express (the executive sponsor's) own commitment to making the project a success	Overview of the session: purpose, expectations, logistics, etc.		¼ hour
Managers' Induction Review vision, benefits, expected results (objectives and measures) Review alignment with Information Technology and corporate strategy Discuss high-level view of the impact of the project on technology, process and people Outline risks associated with the project Review executive decisions already made Introduce steering committee and project team members and roles Refine the stakeholder matrix Review the sponsorship program	Provides opportunity for managers to understand the importance of the project for the organization and their department.		2 hours
Application to Process Overview Conduct session to overview application to process	Highlights how the application modules, relevant to the business processes applicable to the departments' operations, can benefit the departments to improve their performance.		4-6 hours
For Middle Managers: Organizational Performance Improvement Strategy Review the Organizational Performance Improvement Strategy defined for the business unit Give an example of how to drill the organizational performance objectives down to the role and activity level (to be done outside the session) Capture action items	Provides the forum for the middle managers to convert the organizational performance improvement strategy to their department, by focusing on role and activity performance expectations..		2 hours
Change Leadership Guiding Principles and Roles Review examples of recent change and reactions to those changes Discuss guiding principles for effective change leadership Agree on role as change leaders	Highlights the 8 guiding principles to effective change leadership, describes the typical reactions to change and guides the discussion on the roles of the middle managers and first line managers as change leaders.		2 hours
Managers' Communication Guide Review the communication responsibility of managers Link to communication campaign Agree on role as communication agents	Highlights the communication role of managers and provides guidance to help manager fulfill their role as communicator.		1 hour

Managers' Induction

Executive Project Strategy

We discussed the following from the Executive Project Strategy (AP.010) and other project deliverables:

- Background for the decision to go ahead with the project
- Benefits of the project to the organization, the business units, the departments, and to the individual managers
- Implementation Guidelines for a successful application implementation project
- Project vision and expected results (objectives and measures)
- Alignment of project vision with Information Technology and corporate strategy
- High level impact of the project on the organization's current technology, processes and people
- High level risks associated with the project
- Executive decisions, already made
- The members and roles of the steering committee and project team
- Project team charter and the division of responsibilities between the steering committee and the project team
- Performance expectations and the responsibilities of the project team
- Highlights from the Project Readiness Roadmap (AP.070)

Stakeholder Analysis

The following have been identified as key stakeholders by manager:

Sponsorship Profile and Authority

Specific managers' sponsorship responsibilities include:

- Communicate positively and frequently about the project to the people with whom they come into contact
- Provide the "best and brightest" people to the project team
- Be supportive of the people assigned to the project and remove barriers for the people from their departments
- Maintain commitment in themselves for the project throughout its lifecycle

- Analyze and document the changes to the operations, procedures and human performance support systems

Application to Process Overview

Application Modules

The following lists the modules included in the Application to Process Overview:

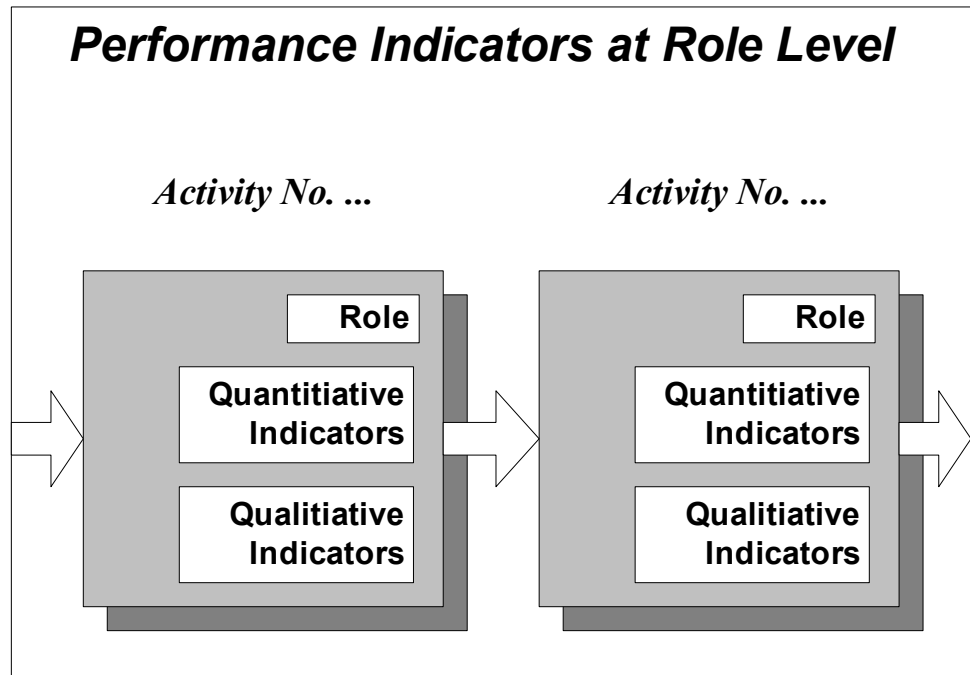
Topics

The following lists the topics included in the Application to Process Overview:

- Highlights
- Introduction
- Structure
- Functionality
- Information Flows
- On-line Demo

Organizational Performance Improvement Strategy

At the department level, the performance expectations are defined per role and activity for each process.



Impacted Process/ Procedure (Level 4 - 5 of Oracle Business Model)	Activities	Role Expectations	Corresponding Organizational Performance Objectives	Criteria
Financial - Accounts Receivable (AR)				
Accounts Receivable	Meet Accounts Receivable Deadlines	Meet accounting deadlines		Meet internal customer expectations
Credit checks	Process incoming order related to credit checks	Determine type of credit type Validate customer viability accurately Maintain credit records		Define credit types Check all questionable reports Less than 5% receivables are aged over 30 days Anything over 30 days is brought to management's attention
Invoices	Process invoices	Process invoices for completed shipments within one working day		Notify management of delays and reasons
Financial - Accounts Payable (AP)				
Approval	Complete the approval process Maintain Electronic Funds Transfer (EFT) data	Approve 100% of all invoices Transfer correct funds		Work within preset approval ranges Work within limits

Impacted Process/ Procedure (Level 4 - 5 of Oracle Business Model)	Activities	Role Expectations	Corresponding Organizational Performance Objectives	Criteria
Close	Complete the closing process	Meet all accounting period driven deadlines Reconciliation completed within accounting guidelines		Work within the predefined accounting schedule
Invoice	Complete invoices	Process invoices within AP guidelines		Work within the predefined accounting guidelines
Payments	Process outgoing payments	Process invoices for best cash management practices		Work within the predefined accounting guidelines
Returned Goods	Follow quality procedures	Process to make sure of credit or reshipment		Comply with money back guarantee and return policy
Financial - Assets				
Manage Assets	Maintain evaluation of fixed and depreciable	Value assets to country specific tax codes Depreciate assets to appropriate tax codes Report status of assets		Work within predefined accounting guidelines
Financial - General Ledger (G/L)				
Close G/L	Complete the closing process	Balance chart of accounts		Work within predefined accounting guidelines
Maintain G/L	Maintain G/L components and chart of accounts	Import other business unit journals Re-value accounts and post entries		Work within the predefined accounting guidelines
Financial - Cost				
Calculate item cost	Set fair market value of produced items	Set labor cost Contract vendors Assign fixed costs		Work within the predefined accounting guidelines
Manufacturing - Bill of Materials (BOM)				
Maintain BOM	BOM System	Define BOM components		Follow guidelines to assemble BOMs that match customer requirements
Item Maintenance	BOM System	Identify differences between existing/new/changed BOMs Modify existing BOMs to meet new customer specs		Follow guidelines to assemble BOMs that match customer requirements
Manufacturing - Quality				
Reliability	Reliability process	Implement monitoring processes Handle item failures and Return Material Authorization (RMA)		Work with customer and manufacturing team to establish item specific quality plans
Ship product	Ship criteria	Perform inspections Pack and test products		Work with customer and manufacturing team to establish item specific test/ship plans
Manufacturing - Materials				
Materials Inventory	Manufacturing	Maintain inventory levels		Analyze manufacturing orders and Work In Progress (WIP) to make sure of adequate raw materials inventory
Manufacturing - Purchasing				

Impacted Process/ Procedure (Level 4 - 5 of Oracle Business Model)	Activities	Role Expectations	Corresponding Organizational Performance Objectives	Criteria
Suppliers	Supply chain	Qualify suppliers to meet item requirements Execute purchase orders to support manufacturing needs Establish autosourcing agreements Put shipments into inventory		Implement quality standards and processes suppliers must maintain All purchase orders will be processed according to priority definition Establish agreements with critical components that enable shipment from automated system notice Verify raw material acceptance criteria
Front Office - Sales & Marketing				
Customer Service	Number of positive interactions Number of negative interactions Elapsed time to service requests Customer retention rate	Achieve referral status for 20% of client base Reduce issues by 50% from previous measures Average response time to improve 20% over previous quarter Rate to exceed industry standard by 10%		Exceed customer expectations Meet customer expectations Coordinate inter-company communication to effectively respond Exceed customer expectations
Customer Process	Error rate Data accuracy	Reduce errors to <10%> of previous measure Reduce ship/communication errors by <5%> of previous measure		Accurately record and verify new and revised information Research errors and correct customer data
Customer Relationship Management	Forecast cycle time Order processing cycle time Delivery cycle time	Increase accuracy of sales forecast by <10%> over previous measure Reduce time from request to acknowledgment to one working day Decrease time between order and shipment by <20%> on existing items		Implement defined processes and software Use technology based order entry system Use the customer service center to coordinate order processing

Documentation Task Force

Oracle Tutor™ is the tool the implementation team is using to document procedures and curriculum, on a role basis, using the library of application supported procedures and courseware.

Like any tool, a successful Oracle Tutor project requires proper staffing of key project functions. The following list describes the functions necessary for a successful Oracle Tutor project. Each function may require multiple full or part-time people, or multiple functions may be filled by a single individual - as determined by the project

complexity and skills of the individuals. The vendor can provide skilled resources if required.

As the department heads, the middle managers are the closest to the business processes and the people who are involved in the improvement of the processes. They are the ones who set up the required Oracle Tutor task force.

Function	Description	Skills Set/Knowledge	Traditional Candidates	Workshop to Attend
Organization Project Manager Always required Part-time for life of project	Has overall responsibility from start through delivery of completed project. Provides management of procedure and courseware development and document publishing. Delivers progress reports to the executive sponsor. Works with the Oracle Tutor lead and learning coordinator (LC) to define learning plan and monitor delivery, while providing guidance to the LC during the execution of all learning activities.	Managing cross functional projects, leadership, working with employees at all levels. Relationships between basic business functions, company policies, business issues	Application implementation team manager User training manager Training department manager Information Technology project manager	Kickoff Procedure Editing Courseware Publisher I and II
Oracle Tutor Lead Always required Level of effort dependent on customer's ability to use the tool and manage such project	Provide guidance to the organization's project manager on the management of the Oracle Tutor implementation. Acts as the primary point of contact on Oracle Tutor issues.	Oracle Tutor implementation cycle and activities Management expertise Organization skills Project management Leadership.	Oracle OCM (OEPC in US)	Kickoff Procedure Editing Courseware Publisher I and II
Process Owner/Subject Matter Specialist (SMS) Always required Involvement part time during procedure editing/development; Ideally, one owner per functional area. Hand off to business process owner at completion of project.	Is responsible for, and provides expertise during, the documentation of business procedures	Leadership, working with employees at all levels Relationships between basic business functions, company policies.	Department managers Department supervisors Project team members	Kickoff Procedure Editing
Courseware Owner Always required Full time involvement of one or more people during courseware modification/development	Is responsible for, and has final decision about the courseware development and modifications	Leadership Working with employees at all levels Application knowledge Instructional design Relationship between basic business functions and company policies	Training department staff Project team member	Kickoff Courseware
Application Implementation Subject Matter Specialist (SMS) Required when process owner is not part of application implementation project team Part-time during development	Provides knowledge of the Oracle applications implementation including any extensions and modifications	Application knowledge Relationship between basic business functions	Oracle application team member	Kickoff Procedure editing Courseware

Function	Description	Skills Set/Knowledge	Traditional Candidates	Workshop to Attend
Document Controller Always required Full time involvement during development. Part to full time ongoing	Controls the publishing and distribution of all documentation, procedures and courseware Provides and manages Oracle Tutor Author editing support for all procedures and courseware documents, based on input from document owners Orchestrates the maintenance of the Oracle Tutor documents Develops/delivers document progress reports	Oracle Tutor Author expertise Touch typing skills (speed not required but helpful) Personal computing on an IBM or compatible, using Windows, Word processing using Microsoft Word for Windows Following up Working with other employees at all levels Knowledge of company policies, procedure writing standards	Documentation group manager Training group manager Desktop publishing manager Courseware developer Oracle OCM (OEPC in US)	Kickoff Procedure Editing Courseware Publisher I and II
Document Specialists Always required Full time involvement during development. Number of people needed depends on number of modules and amount of customization	Provides Oracle Tutor Author editing support for all procedure and courseware documents based on input from process and courseware owners May also participate in curriculum design and development	Oracle Tutor Author expertise Touch typing skills (speed not required but helpful) Personal computing on an IBM or compatible, using Windows, Word processing using Microsoft Word for Windows Following up Working with other employees at all levels Knowledge of company policies, procedure writing standards	Word Processor Technical Writer Oracle OCM (OEPC in US)	Kickoff Procedure Editing Courseware Publisher I and II
Workshop Facilitator Always required 1 resource for Kickoff 2 resources for Procedure Editing Workshop 1 resource for Courseware 1 resource for Publisher I and II	Conducts Oracle Tutor workshops	Oracle Tutor workshop details Classroom management Organization Presentation Working with employees at all levels	Oracle OCM (OEPC in US)	Facilitates: Kickoff Procedure Editing Courseware Publisher I and II
Learning Agents Always required Part or full time involvement depends on learning events schedule	Facilitate learning events for end users	Andragogy Working with people at all levels Organization Instructional design a plus	Implementation team member Training department Oracle OCM (OEPC in US)	Courseware
Delivery Skills Facilitator Required when organization provides Learning agents 3 days per workshop (approximately 10 participants per workshop)	Facilitates workshop with organization's trainers to build andragogy and facilitation skills	Topical knowledge Train the Trainer experience Leadership Facilitation	Oracle OCM (OEPC)	N/A other than for awareness
Learning Needs Analyst Required when detailed task analysis is needed Level of effort depends on number of applications and size of user audience	Provides task level analysis of roles to support the documentation on procedures and to identify organization's user learning requirements.	Communication with people at all levels Organization Instructional designer Human performance technologist Documentation writing Analyst	Oracle OCM (OEPC)	N/A other than for awareness

Function	Description	Skills Set/Knowledge	Traditional Candidates	Workshop to Attend
Learning Coordinator Always required Part or full time involvement: Depends on learning strategy and size of audience as well as role to the Oracle Tutor lead (above)	Coordinates learning activities including scheduling, registration and attendance Works with Oracle Tutor lead and Organization Project manager to define the learning plan and support its execution.	Oracle education expertise Project management Organization Communication with people at all levels Training deployment	Training group staff Oracle OCM (OEPC)	N/A other than for awareness
Network Administrator Always required 4+ days per Oracle Tutor install site	Provides technical support for the installation of the Oracle Tutor documentation files at organization site Responsible for setting up proper file backup procedures	Directory and file structures Networking Client/Server Web server System administration	System administrator Systems analyst Network technician Oracle Education Technical Operations	N/A other than for awareness
Education Technician Always required Level of effort depends on number of modules and learning facilities	Provides technical support for classroom set-up and learning database refresh Responsible for assisting organization with installation of the Oracle Tutor product and technical workshop requirements	Oracle Tutor technical knowledge Database System administration Applications technical	System administrator Systems analyst Oracle Education Technical Operations	N/A other than for awareness

Human Performance Support Systems (HPSS) Task Force

In addition to the Oracle Tutor team, a Human Performance Support System task force is required to assist in the upgrade of the new roles. Starting from the new business process defined/improved, the Human Performance Support Systems (HPSS) task force gets involved with:

Human Performance Support Systems (HPSS) Areas	Example of Activities
Work flows, job structure and organizational structure	Creating/designing job descriptions and work flows, reorganizing departments and business units
Job Performance	Determining new competency models, as well as productivity expectations and other metrics, recommending human resource allocation
Job Evaluation and Classification	Evaluating jobs to assign grade levels, classifications, and possibly compensation ranges
Performance Support Practices, Tools and Systems	Developing tools and procedures: to interview, select, and appraise the performance of those filling new roles; to guide in goal-setting, provision of feedback, and career development, to reward and recognize new behaviors, etc.
Job-Person Matching (when accompanied by a skills assessment)	Developing new skills profiles; may include recommending training and other learning opportunities, as well as succession planning

The Oracle Tutor team members can transition into the Human Performance Support Systems (HPSS) task force as the procedure and content are documented. In addition to the Organization's Tutor project manager, process owner/Subject Matter Specialist

(SMS), courseware owner, application implementation SMS, document specialist, workshop facilitator and learning agent, the HPSS task force requires the following functions:

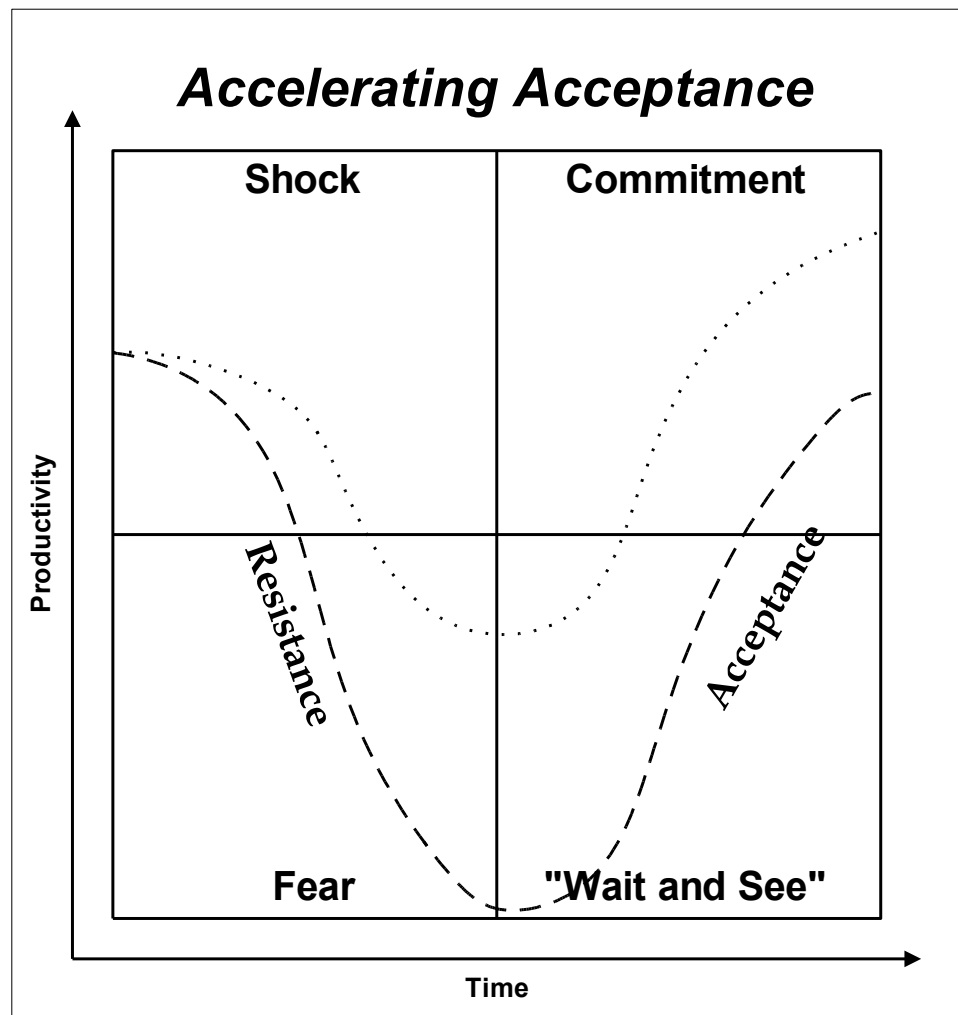
Function	Description	Skills Set/Knowledge	Traditional Candidates
Organizational Development/Human Performance Technologist Required if business processes are changed/improved Level of effort depends on the scope of business process change/improvement	Creates/designs job descriptions and work flows, reorganizes departments and business units Determines new competency models, as well as productivity expectations and other metrics, recommends human resource allocation Develops HR management tools	Organizational development Business Process Improvement Human Performance Technology Human Resource Management Oracle Business Models Experience with technology implementations	Oracle OCM (OEPC in US) Organization Human Resource/Organizational Development (HR/OD) department specialists
Compensation Specialist Required if new roles defined are of a different classification Level of involvement depends on the number of new roles	Evaluates jobs to assign grade levels, classifications, and possibly compensation ranges	Compensation analysis and design	Oracle OCM (OEPC in US) Organization Human Resource/Organizational Development (HR/OD) department specialists

Change Leadership Guiding Principles and Roles

Reactions to Change

Accelerating the Path Through the Valley of Despair

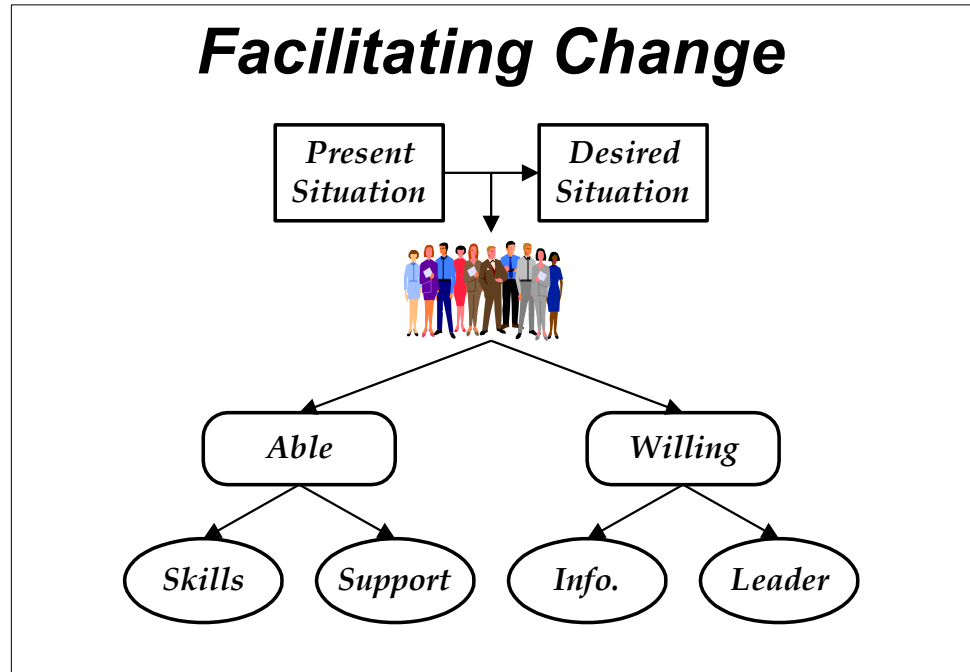
As users react to change through shock, fear and “wait and see” attitude before they commit to the new roles they must fulfill, there is a great drop in productivity. Adoption tasks aim at accelerating the cycle of reaction to change so the productivity drop is lessened and users achieve acceptance faster and generate higher productivity



Change Model

To Change, Individuals Need the Will and the Abilities

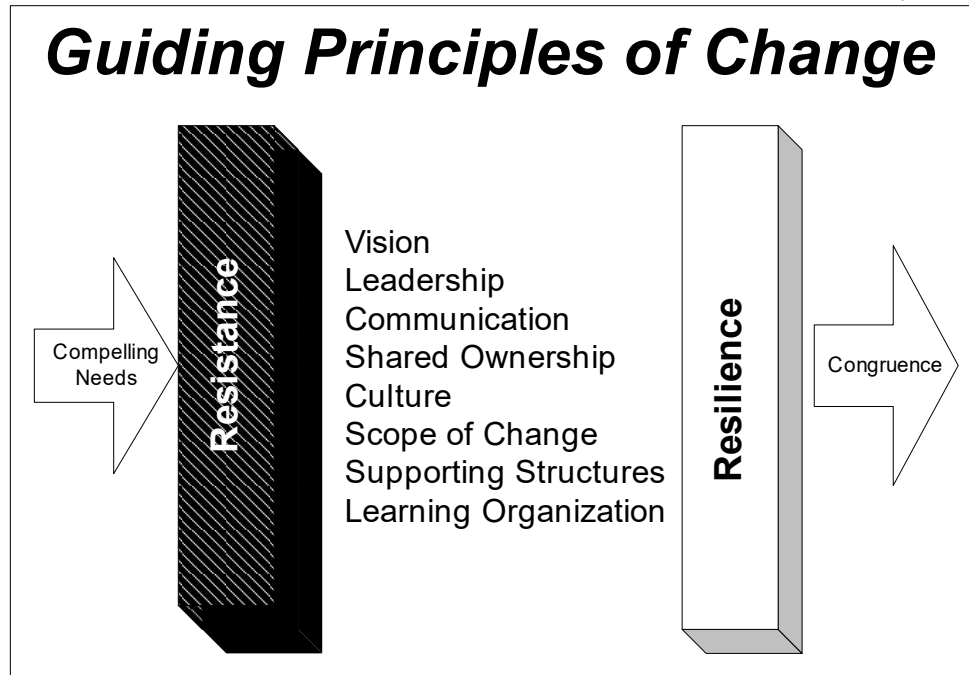
To facilitate the change from the present to the desired situation, users need the will and the abilities to change.



Guiding Principles for Effective Change

Leading Change From Resistance to Resilience

There are eight guiding principles for effective change.



Change Leadership Behaviors

Leaders at all level must participate in the change leadership pattern across the organization. The managers agreed to the following change leadership behaviors:

Guiding Principles	To Do	How To
Create a Clear, Compelling Vision Give a picture of where you are headed Describe how the vision will be achieved Keep it concise	Promote the project vision and keep in the fore front its tie to the corporate strategy Leaders need to be able to dream and do; get some talented dreamers to help you on the team	Think about how the project can best serve your department strategy; dream big. Identify the key benefits of the project for your department and the organization. Distill your thoughts from step one and two above: Is there an underlying theme? Aim for elegant simplicity. Figure out where you are now. Spend enough time to know where you are, but your main focus is on the future. Describe the gap in terms of a compelling need to change (this is the transformation.). Try your project vision statement on everyone you meet. If you can't make others understand in less than three minutes, start over.

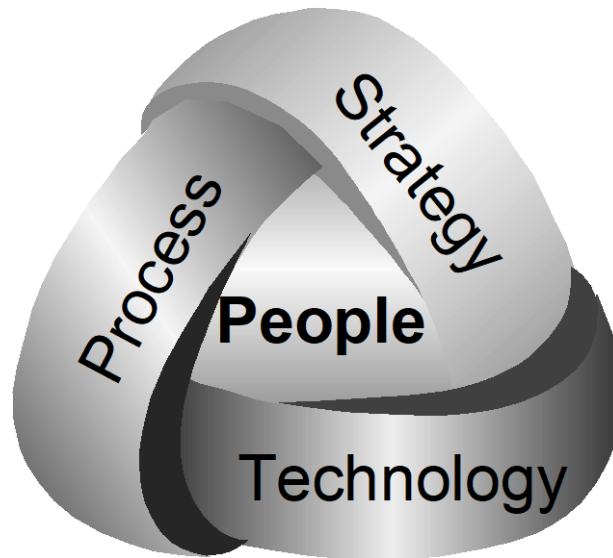
Guiding Principles	To Do	How To
Assess the Organizational Culture Focus on the customer Look for innovation and creativity Encourage risk taking Evaluate teamwork	Assess the current organizational and team culture in your department. Put the focus of the project squarely on the customer. Create a clear path from the customers' needs to the resources that meet those needs and to the project team. Nurture creativity. Don't punish pioneers.	Assess your department's readiness to fulfill the project vision. Hold focus groups and gather feedback on how-we-do-things-around-here. Consider benchmarking from the outside. Choose performance measures which tie directly to customer satisfaction for your department. Involve customers; they are key stakeholders in the project; ask for their feedback and if appropriate their participation as liaisons to change teams. Ask your first line managers and employees what could be done to allow them to serve the project customers better. Provide opportunities for ideas to surface throughout your department. Recognize and reward innovation. Recognize some important near misses.
Lead the Way Assemble a coalition Function as a sponsor Serve as role model Create a sense of urgency Endure to the end	Begin with yourself. If you don't role model the future, no one will. Find influential allies who share the project vision. Accelerate the pace just enough to create the right sense of urgency and momentum. Create early wins and communicate those wins. Endure to the end.	Ruthlessly examine yourself to determine how your behavior and approach to the project work, values, plans align with the project vision. Get feedback from others. Walk the talk. Do things highly visible to make the change real. Slay a sacred cow. Assign the managers reporting to you (communication agents) the task of spreading the word throughout the department. Use hard, cold facts to keep the compelling need for change in plain sight. Set stretch goals. Monitor, measure, celebrate, and set new goals. Cherry pick – find early wins, publicize, reward, celebrate. Give presentations; conduct one-on-ones, focus groups, town hall sessions; preside at celebrations; remove barriers; provide resources.
Manage the Scope of Change Stay within people's finite capacity to absorb change Keep an "open system" approach: systems are inter-dependent, multi-dimensional: change one, change all Tie to the vision, to keep the change into context	Assess your people's capacity for change. Lobby to kill, merge or delay any non-essential project in your department and across the organization. Define the big picture; let people see how initiatives interrelate. Establish strong ties to the corporate strategy.	Review data to inventory current changes in your department and detect people's capacity to absorb change. Gather information on all major projects. Look for objectives, overlaps, conflicts, commonality, scope, and time frames. Help validate the project as priority. Integrate, harmonize remaining projects.

Guiding Principles	To Do	How To
Communicate Openly, Honestly, Relentlessly More is better: Repeat key messages through different sources, consistently Open two way communication channels Manage the information; keep no secrets	Determine your department's preferred ways of communication. Create a formal plan for two-way communication. Use communication agents. Broadcast successes. Keep abreast of people's needs for communication and meet those needs. Measure the effectiveness of the communication. Manage rumors at their onset.	Create a supportive environment for the communication agents and the two-way communication channels throughout your department. Use communications (two-way) to: - Create buy-in - Glean ideas you may not have thought of - Build trust - Build enthusiasm - Determine where resistance lies - Estimate the strength of the resistance - Determine the causes of the resistance - Clear up misconceptions - Figure out how far and fast people can move - Make course corrections - Find pockets of support - Surface concerns rather than suppress them
Promote Shared Ownership Involve: People support what they help to create Ownership improves quality and relevancy of decisions: involve everyone, involve them early	Identify opinion leaders in your department. Determine whose support is critical and whose opposition could be dangerous. Find opportunities to create buy-in among managers reporting to you and employees..	Create a matrix that shows impacted groups within your department and anticipated support levels (Stakeholder matrix). In critical areas, get down to an individual level. Identify their stake in the change. Assess their readiness to change. Hold focus groups with representative sample of highly impacted groups. Hold one-on-one sessions with key stakeholders in your department. Involve stakeholders in your department in supporting the project, ideas generation, focus groups, change teams, communication, and problem solving sessions.
Create Supporting Structures Streamline decision making process Make rewards and recognition supportive of vision Instill measurements tied to the vision Align human resource systems with required behaviors	Keep bureaucracy to a minimum. Create reward systems specially for the project. Adopt measures to focus on the transformations critical to the project vision. Look for disconnects between HR policies and project set up/vision. Adjust HR systems accordingly.	Keep layers in the hierarchy to a minimum. Push authority and accountability down. Define the behaviors which are conducive to achieving the project's business vision. Mix measures; hard, soft, financial, non-financial, process and results. Provide the right learning events. Make participation on the project team a career enhancer for the resource selected from your department.
Build A Learning Organization Operate on an assumption of competence Create safe environment for learning Promote knowledge transfer	Lend the "best and brightest" to the project Encourage knowledge sharing Promote voluntary followership Unite people behind the project through shared vision, shared values, shared purpose Regard mistakes as learning steps Provide learning opportunities	Encourage individual characteristics which a learning organization should recognize and reward: self-directed learning, respect for others, empathy, curiosity, listening, systems thinking (ability to see how things are interconnected), risk taking, two way communication – dialogue, humility (being teachable), ability to learn from mistakes, self-knowledge – aware of strengths and weaknesses Weave learning through status reporting

Managers' Communication Guide

The Need to Involve People

People are at the heart of all change, especially technological change, as suggested by the picture below. People impacted by change often experience fear, anger, and anxiety because their professional (as well as personal) equilibrium is threatened. They must adjust the way they work (technology), the way they cooperate with co-workers or other teams (process), and the roles they play in the company's business strategy (strategy).



People at the heart of change

People will decide whether to use technology to its fullest or only for administrative convenience. Seventy-four percent of system implementations fail to meet expectations or are only partly used. Technological implementations fail because organizations neglect to manage the change. People must be involved in any change project to enhance the likelihood of success.

<Company Long Name> wants to positively manage change and its impact on their employees. <Company Long Name> wants to actively involve their people in this process. The first steps toward achieving this goal require good communication with employees, sensitivity to their concerns, their participation in and input to the process and, naturally, management of their expectations.

Purpose of this Guide

This guide provides information and an orientation to support your involvement in and your commitment to the communication process for <Project Name>.

You will see how you can enhance the communication process and how to fulfill your role as a manager supporting people through change. This guide covers:

- importance of communications to the success of <Project Name>;

- mandate of the communication team;
- communication strategies to use during change;
- tactics to manage reactions and resistance.

Role of Your Communication Team in the <Project Name>

We know that people are the key to successful change. To be in touch with them, it's important to communicate openly, honestly and consistently.

Communications are a chief focus of the <Project Name> team. We are committed to conducting formal communications that will proceed in a "cascading" manner and be aligned with the implementation milestones. These cascading communications target details appropriate to each particular message and flow through established management and organizational channels from within the respective departments to frontline employees. As managers, you play an active role in this cascading communication.

Your Communication Structure for the <Project Name>

A communication team is in place to provide the necessary support to all business units, departments and work groups to ease the implementation of the <Project Name>. The project communication team outlined the high-level guidelines enabling communication work to go forward based on the communication orientations (See Communication Strategy in the Project Readiness Roadmap, AP.070). It involves formal and informal leaders to manage all communication channels. It also coordinates the production of communication tools.

The communication team is essential to the success of <Project Name>. The members represent the various communication audiences and other stakeholders. The specific role of the managers is to support communication with his/her stakeholders.

Here are the people involved in this team for <Project Name>:

- the executive project sponsor is <Name>,
- the business project sponsors are <Names>,
- the project team includes <Names>,
- the communication agents are <Names>, and
- the communication liaisons are <Names>.

Your Communication Campaign

The communication team develops a communication campaign that best meets the needs and concerns of each project audience (groups).

Purpose of the Communication Campaign

The purpose of the Communication Campaign is to:

- support the technological implementation;
- manage ambiguity and reduce chaos;
- create a rallying point for people;
- help people tie individual and team efforts to a larger cause;
- create momentum for change;
- address issues;
- satisfy the hunger for information;
- control and channel rumors;
- give each audience a channel for two-way communication with the <Project Name> team.

Steps to Develop the Communication Campaign Materials

The Communication Campaign materials are created through a series of steps:

- clarify change objectives of the project and change leader's vision;
- identify and assess audiences (specific groups impacted by the project) as to their communication needs, and to identify concerns as well as cultural preferences;
- tailor messages and events for each audience;
- plan, develop, and roll-out the campaign;
- measure the effectiveness of the Communication Campaign and adjust it as needed;
- create specific communications targeted to situations which could create resistance, political struggle, or ambiguity.

The Communication Team

The communication team leads all dedicated communications related to <Project Name>. It includes communication agents and liaisons.

Communication Agents

The communication agents are involved in all steps of the communication campaign. The specific role of the communication agents is to lead the following tasks with input from communication liaisons:

- help prepare audience analysis and tailor key messages for each audience and communication needs;
- recommend communication effectiveness measurement method(s);
- develop the communications per phase;
- solicit nominations for communication liaisons;

- develop communication liaison preparation materials and deploy the communication campaign;
- assist communication liaisons in their role;
- provide guidance for local communication;
- measure results of the campaign;
- plan celebration events and recommend individuals and teams to be recognized.

Communication Liaisons

The role of the communication liaison is key to the two-way, tailored approach to communication for <Project Name>. You play an advocacy and ambassadorial role. The project needs your energy, your enthusiasm, your commitment, your candor and your diplomacy.

With the assistance of the communication agents, communication liaisons will:

- help identify people or groups (audiences) who will be the most impacted and tailor communications to address their concerns;
- represent their constituency with their needs, concerns, hopes and issues;
- open the two way communication channel between their constituency and the project team;
- make sure that all people who will be impacted by the change understand the change;
- build common understanding and informed support during the project;
- provide, throughout the project, maximum responsiveness;
- create processes for rumor control.

Managers will support this communication effort, by being aware of the communication events which will impact their department/plant. You are the official communication channel and are the voice of your people in all two-way communication. In fact, you contribute and benefit from the synergy of the communication team. Your participation with communication measurements (feedback, focus group, survey, etc.) can influence the Communication Campaign and enhance its key messages and communication events.

Your Contribution

Managing change on a daily basis while experiencing it yourself is difficult. You find yourself challenged to communicate clearly while dealing with the ambiguity of transition. In addition, running the business during change requires flexibility and leadership to keep people moving forward. Managers face this reality during technological change and make sure that their people receive all the support they need to embrace the changes and continue to perform in the new business process.

In this situation, effective communications encourage a successful transition and reduce barriers to productivity, which are:

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People will grieve for the “good old days”, and this is okay. Effective managers will support people through the process by listening to them, answering their questions, moving through their reactions toward commitment, and creating an atmosphere conducive to open communication.

Your Leadership

Managing people’s reactions obviously demands leadership on the part of the managers. We are referring here to both personal and professional talents. In fact, communicating during change relies more on the managers’ personal skills than on their knowledge. These skills are the very source of all good management but are even more indispensable in a context of change, where strong reactions and deep resistance require skilled intervention.

<Company Long Name> requires your leadership to create an environment that fosters an openness to change and that readily leads to the adoption of new ways of doing things and people follow because you:

- have the reputation of being trustworthy and honest;
- believe in this project;
- say the truth;
- speak openly;
- address their needs and concerns.

Your Communication Ability

As manager you have formal and informal opportunities to communicate with your people. You know what is the most efficient medium (meeting, memo, individual discussion, etc.) to pass messages and encourage discussion. You are in a position to support two-way communication and make sure project buy-in. <Project Name> requires your communication ability to:

- actively listen to people;
- pass messages clearly;
- support the communication strategy for the success of this project;
- serve as an advocate for your <Department/Plant> and your people;
- lead and facilitate discussions;
- solicit feedback;
- distinguish rumor from facts for your people.

Your Flexibility

Every day throughout the change you will have to make sure that your people measure up to their individual and group goals. You will have to win them over and keep them involved. Manager flexibility is crucial to the organization reaching its change goals. <Company Long Name> needs your flexibility to:

- question the status quo;
- encourage people to challenge ideas;
- develop good ideas for the transition phase;
- support communication events to keep employees involved;
- generate trust and candid input.

Your Cultural Sensitivity

Managers build the organizational culture every day. Sensitivity to the culture helps the implementation team to be:

- aware of and concerned with your people;
- respectful of diversity in the organization;
- sensitive to the psychological dynamics of change;
- able to use creativity to identify strategies to involve people in the project.

Your Expertise as Manager

Your personal <Department/Plant> expertise will enhance the discussion and add value to the <Project Name>. Your involvement in the communication campaign supports changes at all levels of the organization. Your participation is crucial to strengthening the link between the <Project Name> team and your people.

With You

Your role is key to the success of <Project Name>. Through you:

- people impacted by the <Project Name> will have a clear understanding of the importance of the project and specifically how it will impact them;
- communication agent and communication liaison will have strong sponsors.

Effective Day to Day Communications

This section provides you with information on how to deal day after day with people impacted by change. You will face positive and negative reactions. Both are normal but need to be managed to keep expectations realistic and reduce resistance.

People undergo a specific psychological process before they arrive at a new work situation. They need to be supported in overcoming the fears that change generates. To counteract the fear of the unknown and to support mobilization and motivation in favor of the change, managers have to communicate honestly, relentlessly, and in a different manner. This section provides suggestions to support communication initiatives.

The communication flow is very sensitive in organizations and may create political issues if ignored or not supported by the managers. Information flowing through informal channels is particularly powerful. That's why sharing information is an art. What you can and should say is not always clear. The most effective way to communicate is: say the truth.

Tell the Truth

Say the truth and clearly communicate what will be done. It's alright to say "I don't know", to admit bad news, or to acknowledge that change often scares people. Saying the truth respects people's intelligence. We all prefer the truth rather than a political statement. The worst thing for an audience is to feel manipulated, or unheard.

There is a way to say the truth and describe the realistic picture. The approach must:

- be credible;
- be honest;
- be open;
- be timely,
- invite input and participation;
- display active listening;
- provide opportunities to share in the decision-making process;
- be genuine.

Use your strengths to communicate: humor, demonstration, concrete examples applicable to your group, etc. Most important is to communicate with integrity and with congruence, where your words, your tone, and your body language all communicate the same message. To make sure that what you say and how you say it are in sync, you must be comfortable with your message and how you communicate this message.

Honesty and forthrightness are a new practice in many organizations and could surprise many people. They will need time to believe and trust the new communication model. Relentless communication is the key to developing that belief and trust. We believe in practicing the "7 x 7 Communication Model." This means that we need to convey our message 7 times, in 7 different ways. The reason is simple: people are individuals, and all of us hear and respond in different ways to different forms of communication.

Respect Effective Timing

You will be exposed to a voluminous flow of information. Some of that information needs to be timed, that is, must be communicated at the right time by the right person and with a specific medium. If the manager does not respect that need, there is a risk of communications becoming garbled, and the possibility of failure and significant negative consequences such as:

- generation of rumors;
- implementation delays;
- creating political issues;
- building resistance at different levels;
- losing sponsorship from target audiences;
- creating confusion between the implementation team and the project communication team;
- reducing project communication team credibility;

- creating a scapegoat;
- losing momentum.

Consequently it's very important to be aware of the communication plan and support its events in your department/plant. The information will be communicated, but success depends on timing. In some cases, prematurely giving out or unnecessarily delaying information would reduce its value and impact. As managers, you:

- sponsor some communication events to make sure of mobilization;
- support the communication process to give visibility;
- communicate some key messages to support building momentum;
- know the calendar of communication events to emphasize the importance of the information;
- use your own communication channels to reinforce communication efforts;
- advise the communication team of new communication needs in your sector.

Your Own Strategies to Support Communication Efforts

Renew Your Understanding of Your People

One strategy to keep in touch with your people during change, is to renew your understanding of employees' attitudes toward the project. Use the following information-gathering activities to enhance your communication process:

- listen and share comments overheard;
- use informal, impromptu discussions;
- pose a few key questions to informal leaders;
- question-and-answer sessions following a formal communication;
- review existing publications for concerns or comments.

The best strategy for efficient communications is "the three to one rule": talk... listen, listen, listen...., talk... listen, listen, listen....

Facing Reactions

Here are some tactics to deal with real negative behaviors and attitudes:

Encouraging healthy skepticism

You can redirect people's reactions to change. In fact, you can create an effective communication channel, but still face people who are slow to embrace the change being communicated. People adopt and adapt to change at different rates. For example, someone may not seem to be honoring the new project or might be asking a lot of questions. This behavior can reflect a valid "Show me, prove it to me" attitude. When this healthy skepticism is addressed, we often find that these people become true disciples. Other people in the organization often watch to see how these "bellwether" types are perceived and treated. Creating an environment where openness, candor, and questions are encouraged could make sure that employees will be part of the solution and not part of the problem.

Handling challenging situations

- with an **autocrat** (a person who wants to control everything, criticizes opposite opinions, could be aggressive): reinforce your point by using this type of person's own logic coupled with your own message: "as you said last week, all people need to be involved in this project.. that's why we want to be in touch with you." "I agree with you, we can't manage change without learning ... for this reason we will assess the stakeholders." Do not fall into this person's trap by using aggressive behavior, it would only worsen the situation. Always be calm and assertive, not aggressive. Refuse or report the discussion if this person is too cynical or violent.
- with a **bungler** (a person who starts rumors, uses indirect strategies to resist, uses ambiguity in communications): identify this person's communication channel and use it for your communication. Clarify your message when this person tries to introduce confusion and if necessary put the message in writing. Enlist the support of informal leaders to stick to the clear message.
- with a **know-it-all** (a person who never makes mistakes, who always has the answer and could be condescending): present your opinions in question form. In meetings, ask this type of person to summarize ideas, give power to other people and cut off that person's speaking, if necessary. Hold to your facts.
- with a **shrinking violet** (a person who has information, but it's not easy for that type of person to communicate it; that person is afraid of conflicts, doesn't speak a lot and has good ideas): open an individual conversation with this person. Use your nonverbal skills to support that person's speaking and give that person your support. Express how you appreciate that person's comments.

When You Make Presentations or Facilitate a Meeting

Presentations are used to make sure of communication, that is, to create two-way communication with employees, to involve people in the project, to clarify messages, and to open discussion. Each presentation must be relevant if you want to keep people's participation and interest.

Remember, in many cases, the time spent preparing the communication is as significant to the success of the communication as the presentation itself. Use the material the communication team provides to you. For the presentation:

- be concrete and use examples for optimal relevancy so people will not have the feeling that you want to trap them in theoretical concepts;
- capture your two or three key messages and reinforce them by presenting their content in different forms (remember the 7x7 model);
- keep in mind that people have seven basic questions about the project: who, what, when, where, why, how and **What about Me?**;
- making a presentation doesn't mean that the presenter does not listen. A presentation is an interactive process: give people time to ask questions, comment on information, exchange ideas, and discuss issues in small groups;
- manage your presentation to focus on a few vital issues. It could be difficult to solve all issues in one exchange with people;
- use the medium as a message itself and don't forget that flashy doesn't always equal compelling or creative;

- if “location, location, location” are the three most important rules in real estate, then the three most important elements of presentations are: “rehearse, rehearse, rehearse”.

Here are a few points to consider for your presentations:

Presentations
• The first message of the presentation is the most important. People always remember how you open a presentation; • Be concrete; • Speak clearly, with good pronunciation and look at your audience (don't read text); • Be interactive with the audience: ask questions, invite comments, use group or personal experiences; • Generate effective interaction: rephrase some important interventions, move, smile, use humor if you are comfortable with it; • Have your introduction and conclusion summarize the discussions; • Be attentive to your nonverbal communication, to make sure of your congruence; • Keep in your mind where the presentation fits in the Communication Campaign; • Clarify all misunderstandings that arise during the discussion period: repeat your key messages; • Target specific issues.

Sponsor a Communication Team Initiative

Co-facilitation is a team effort. Having a manager as co-facilitator can increase communication credibility and emphasize the message. This strategy is useful for creating depth and varied communication. Some conditions have to be present to make sure of success with this activity:

- follow the communication objectives;
- define roles to be consistent and efficient during the presentation;
- present the key messages;
- respect both person's contributions;
- split responsibilities between facilitators.

If these conditions are not present, you risk:

- creating a climate of domination in which everybody loses;
- speaking at the same time and creating confusion for the audience;
- generating inconsistent messages;
- showing disagreement;
- increasing resistance.

As sponsor you could answer stakeholders' concerns and clarify some points, a concrete demonstration of cooperation and teamwork during the change process. The sponsor influences people to support the change. You could create coalitions around the project and bring your own social network into the project. Your commitment gives credibility to the change and exercises an important influence on the project.

You might help the communication initiatives if you:

- speak to your informal channels and reinforce the communication activities;
- provide your analysis of the political situation;

- validate some strategies with communication agent or communication liaison;
- are involved in conflict resolution;
- co-facilitate in a presentation.

Communication to Manage Resistance

The individuals who resist are not necessarily operating in bad faith. They are primarily looking for assurance that their needs and requests will be honored. For them, change raises the specter of losing their personal security, typically developed with great effort over a period of many years. Other groups/individuals resist change until they fully understand the foundation and motives for the change, and still they remain skeptical.

In the organization you find people resisting change because they will be losing their membership group and their affiliations (department mergers, structural changes). In fact, some changes jeopardize the hierarchy of power between employee groups. Others disrupt emotional and social ties between individuals. The loss of power (corporate resistance) and affiliation (social resistance) can create resistance.

Key components of any action strategy to manage resistance are the “interpersonal” skill of the managers who guides employees through the change. The way they communicate with people who might be manifesting resistance makes the difference between having people for the change, or against it, between success, or failure.

Here are some tactics for dealing with resistance. Be aware that action strategies for handling resistance are not recipes. They are examples currently used by various organizations to dispel resistance. You may draw on these strategies, but you will have to adapt them to your own organization’s culture. Those most likely to succeed will be selected according to the skills, strengths, and political forces at play within the organization

Rational Resistance: Inform, Listen, and Provide Opportunities for Input

The individuals and groups who show rational resistance assign credibility to the transparency of communications, to the logic of arguments, and to the congruence of messages. They are therefore especially sensitive to any inconsistency on the part of the manager. In fact, these groups and individuals prefer to hear a harsh truth over an evasive answer, and an imperfect message over a delayed response.

Communications with rational people must:

- explain the why and the how of change;
- provide information on upcoming stages;
- create opportunities for them to say what they think and put their ideas to use;
- repair all miscommunications to prevent rumors;
- acknowledge when there is not yet an answer to the question and remind people that this is a normal phenomenon associated with the transition phase;
- discuss with them (individually, in groups, or through a workshop);

- argue both sides of change: raising the cost of not changing (loss of competitive edge, loss of market, etc.) instead of mentioning only the advantages of the change. In some cases, you must also communicate what will not change;
- address the loss and sadness involved, since change also exacts an emotional toll.

Emotional Resistance: Validate Emotions and Relate It to Change

For many individuals experiencing fear, anxiety, or anger, all they need in order to relieve their discomfort is someone to listen. Others are reassured by the opportunity to discuss their feelings openly with another individual or with a group. Some are appeased by the knowledge that their concerns are normal and accepted by their immediate superior.

Employees who manifest emotional resistance are generally employees who assign a great deal of importance to the work climate, and to their relationships with coworkers. These are employees for whom communication is vital.

Communications with people expressing emotional reactions must:

- validate emotions and situate them in the normal context of change;
- use symbolic communication. Messages associated with visual symbols (a link with the market, the profession, the type of work) or literary symbols (normal, specialized, or humorous language) can strengthen the message and add another level of understanding, while enhancing their receptivity. Marking technological implementation milestones with events that have symbolic connotations (launch a demo with an invitation to hit golf balls or to attend the new system's christening) can help demystify the change or make it more accessible;
- reach employees who talk little and who operate in isolation. Initiate individual conversation with them to avoid passive reaction (illness, declining job performance, etc.) and prevent disengagement;
- use emotional leaders to pass the information and open communication with silent people;
- use informal channels to reach people who do not speak but have important things to say on the change process;
- acknowledge and bring conflicts into the open to restore communications between belligerents;
- acknowledging loss is essential to the grief process. Some organizations even launch the final phase of the change with a ceremony honoring the past;
- demonstrate a concern for fairness in a context of transparency.

Cultural Resistance: Recognize Everyone's Value

Obviously, the values and standards of the organizational culture will be affected by technological changes. The organization, like the individuals, is susceptible to change and can also manifest resistance through its managers. Indeed, changes to

the culture impact personal values by confronting both organizational values as well as those of the group in question.

The culture of change colors every new attempt to interrupt the status quo. In the case of corporate mergers, culture shock can be the root of failed integration. The problem of acculturation is one of the most difficult to manage.

In a cultural change context, communications must:

- integrate key messages to turn cultural differences between groups into assets;
- avoid the creation of sterile cultural communications with which no one identifies;
- present cultural differences as enriching rather than confronting;
- officially acknowledge the complementary contribution of workers from different backgrounds or groups;
- respect the language used by each profession to avoid creating a dominant culture;
- support celebratory events to reinforce the new organizational culture;
- enhance content that encourages openness to the cultures within the organization (tolerance, listening);
- provide information about the organization's policies, client approach, etc.;
- highlight success stories during implementation to support the new emerging culture.

Social Resistance

The loss of power (corporate resistance) and affiliation (social resistance) can create resistance and start competition, or more overt conflicts, between groups having different interests. In this case, some groups use the incoherence of the conveyed messages to reposition themselves according to their social or corporate interests. In this situation, people resist change because they will be losing their membership group and their affiliations (department mergers, structural changes). In addition, some changes exacerbate internal disputes between employee groups (for example, between sales and operations, between unionized and non-unionized staff).

Communications in a social resistance context must:

- reinforce by its messages that the administrative standards, the task assignment process, wage adjustments, and so on are being applied fairly for all groups;
- emphasize that the client is the organization's reason for being and remains the focus of every effort;
- hold rallying events around a common interest;
- reinforce key messages on the Organizational Vision;
- spotlight efforts headed in the direction proposed by the change;
- strengthen the sense of belonging and reduce competitiveness between groups by highlighting collective initiatives and achievements;

- avoid messages that use language containing negative symbols:
sarcastic allusions, or black humor, aimed at a specific employee group should
be avoided in all formal and informal communications by managers.

Open and Closed Issues for this Deliverable

Open Issues

ID	Issue	Resolution	Responsibility	Target Date	Impact Date

Closed Issues

ID	Issue	Resolution	Responsibility	Target Date	Impact Date